

SOME STILL HONOR THE
DEAD WITH SKY BURIAL,
TRUSTING THE OLD WAY
TO SEND SOULS TO THE
AFTERLIFE THROUGH A
MONSTROUS BEAK ...

UNTIL POWER-HUNGRY INTRUDERS DISTURB ...

The CHARNEL PIT of the CORPSE DEMON

1 The Entrance

A natural cave gives way to rough-hewn stone hallways. 3 **zealous thugs**, eager to stamp out illicit religion, nervously argue about who's in charge if the Inquisitor doesn't return.

Zealous Thugs: LV1, AC12, HP4, ATK cudgel d6. Brigid (*ponytail, fiery, brash*), Amos (*bald, stupid, sincere*), & Hask (*eyepatch, untrusting, untrustworthy*) carry a **silver Divining Rod** (detect evil 1/day).

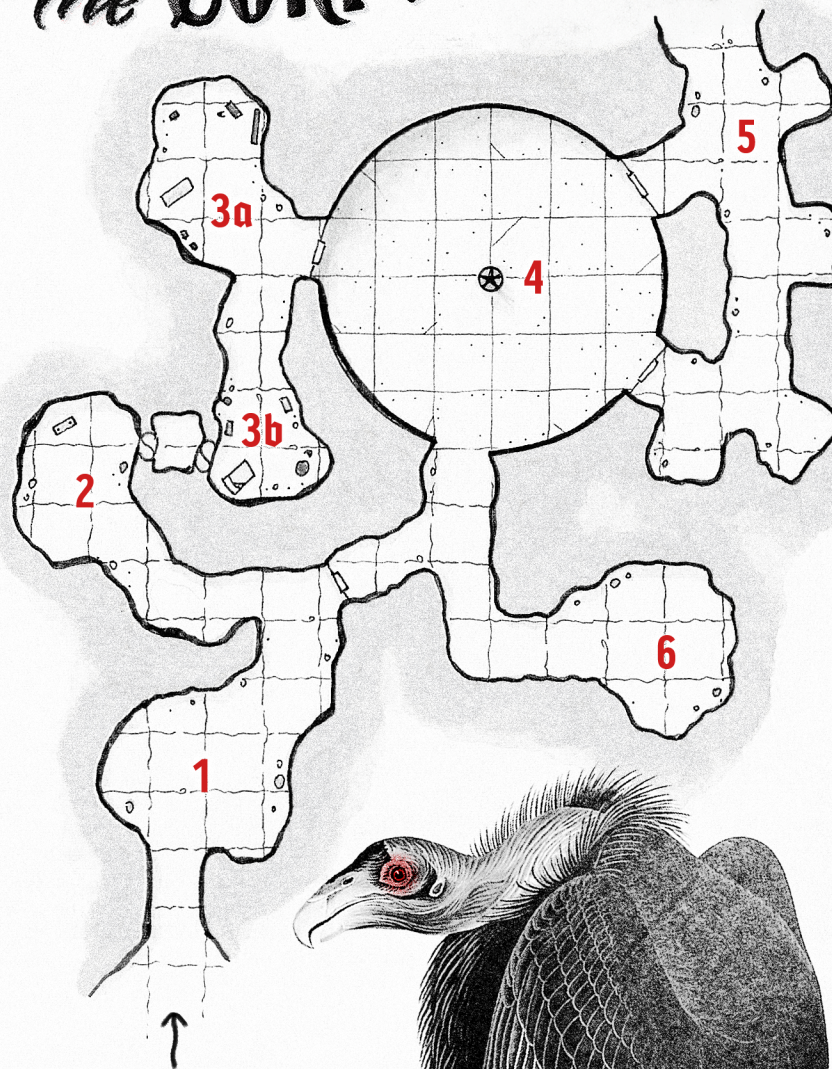
2 The Shrine

A slate altar to some carrion god, studded with unlit candles. Faint smell of jasmine. **Coin offerings**, sticky with curdled blood, are scattered on the floor (227gp, *save vs. poison*). Lighting the candles opens a secret door to 3.

3 The Ossuary

Shelves of skulls line an improvised necromancer's hideout. 3a is a laboratory with a desk, book shelf, and operating table where **Igoryphus** is reanimating a corpse. 3b is a well-furnished sleeping quarter with a thurible of jasmine incense and the **Manticore's Tooth** (*serrated dagger, always poisoned*) in a drawer. A secret door to 2 is hidden behind an **occult tapestry** (150gp, *cursed*).

Igoryphus Slimeborn: LV4, AC12, HP18, ATK 2x arcane bolts d6 or Poison Web. *Cobalt robes, sibilant whispers. Cruel, craven, lonely. Trying to raise an undead army to fight his battles for him. Carries a Wand of Sleep.*



ENTER THROUGH THE HILLSIDE
CAVE, OR BY CLIMBING
INTO THE CHARNEL PIT 4

4 The Pit

Cavernous shaft for sky burial, 60' tall, open on top. d6 **starving vultures** circle above. Sandy floor covered in hundreds of sun-bleached bones, but no recent corpses. Drag marks lead to locked door to 3. Risky climb down or out.

Starving Vultures: LV1, AC10, HP5, ATK Beak d4

5 The Crypt

A dusty stone hallway with six quiet burial niches. 1-3: **zombie** and 3d12gp. 4: **Jade Burial Mask in the image of a serpent** (450gp, *protected by poison gas trap*). 5: **Lewd Amphora** (320gp, *very fragile*). 6: The **inquisitor**, hiding in a bronze sarcophagus with the **key** to 3. Loud noise attracts attention.

Inquisitor Ogbert: LV3, AC15, HP14, ATK Blessed Warhammer d10 or Holy Ward. *Puritan hat, mutton chops. Grim, paranoid, hard of hearing. Willing to help fight evil; not willing to share treasure; believes all magic is evil.*

Zombies: LV 2, AC8, HP10, ATK Rotfist d6
1:2 chance to *reanimate* with 1hp on death.

6 The Lair

Musty cave carpeted with bones and giant feathers. Smell of rancid meat and vomit. The **Corpse Demon** roosts here in fitful slumber (1-in-6 chance it wakes up each turn). The **Plumed Helm of the Boar Knight** (*attack with advantage on the charge*) is buried in the nest.

Corpse Demon: LV6, AC14, HP30, ATK 2x claws d8 or Stunning Shriek. *Large, gaunt vulture-griffon with gore-slick feathers. Eternally hungry, hates the taste of undead and the smell of jasmine.*

Random Encounters: 1. Grey Ooze 2. d4 Starving Vultures 3. d3 Zombies 4. Marjivar, occult bird watcher.

Adventure by **Brian Fox**. Layout by **Hilary Commer**.
Map by **Richelle Thompson** (@soundpukeygirl_maps).
Thanks to NPR's Radiolab, JH, AB, & The Last Garrison. Happy 40th, DS.
[HTTPS://CREATIVECOMMONS.ORG/LICENSES/BY-SA/4.0/](https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by-sa/4.0/)